四篇课文
英文 · 中文 逐词直译对照

Unit 1 · Text 1 / Text B
Unit 6 · Text A / Text B

阅读方式：
黑字英文原文在上，红字中文直译在下，
逐词（短语）上下对应。

Unit 1 • Text 1

Close Your Eyes and Imagine China (闭上双眼，想象中国)

Close your eyes and imagine China, home to 1.4 billion of the world's population.

闭上你的眼睛 然后想象中国， 14 亿 世界人口的家园。

What do you see? Rice paddies; pointed little hats strapped on under the chin; long, wispy mustaches floating above the wide grin of a country farm worker?

你看到了什么？ 稻田； 尖尖的小帽子 用带子系在下巴下面； 长长的、稀疏的胡须 漂浮在咧开的大嘴上方 （那是）一个乡下农场工人的？

Well, while agriculture is still one of China's biggest industries, a lot has changed since China's origins thousands of years ago.

不过， 虽然农业仍然是 中国最大的产业之一， 很多事情已经改变了 自中国起源 数千年以来。

Today, the state of modern China and its innovations are changing the game for what people think about this oriental giant.

如今， 现代中国的面貌 以及它的创新 正在改变（人们的）认知 （改变）人们对……的看法 关于这个东方巨人的。

So, here are a few things to bring you up to speed on modern China.

所以， 这里有几件事 让你跟上（了解） 关于现代中国的（现状）。

China has the fastest trains in the world.

中国拥有最快的火车 在世界上。

In a country as large as China, people need to get around, and quick!

在一个 像中国一样大的国家， 人们需要四处出行， 而且要快！

The Shanghai Maglev is the world's fastest commercial train, clocking in at 430 kph.

上海磁悬浮列车 是世界上速度最快的商业列车， 时速高达 430 公里。

When you are in China's capital of Beijing, you can travel to the shiny city of Shanghai on one of these bullet trains in around 4½ hours.

当你在 中国的首都北京时， 你可以前往 光彩熠熠的上海城 乘坐其中一列高铁 大约 4 个半小时。

In addition, you can hop on a train and arrive at the doorsteps of major attractions such as the Terracotta Warriors in Xi'an, often with less hassle and a similar speed to flying,

此外， 你可以跳上一列火车 到达……的门前 各大著名景点 比如西安的兵马俑， 通常更省事 而且速度堪比飞机，

as the second-longest railway network in the world connects every major city in the Chinese mainland.

因为（拥有）世界第二长的铁路网 在世界（范围内） 连接着每一个主要城市 在中国大陆的。

China goes boldly where no man has gone before.

中国大胆前行 前往前人未至之地。

Not to be confused with the Pink Floyd album, China has become the first country to land a spacecraft on the dark side of the moon.

不要与……混淆 平克·弗洛伊德的专辑（同名）， 中国已成为第一个国家 让航天器着陆 在月球背面。

The Chang'e-4 mission in January 2019 aimed to study the composition and geology of the moon's unexplored region,

嫦娥四号任务 于 2019 年 1 月 旨在研究 （月球的）构成和地质 （那是）月球尚未探索的区域，

which fills a void in the experts' understanding of the universe, and provides new insights into the formation and evolution of the solar system.

这填补了空白 在专家们对……的认知中 （关于）宇宙的， 并提供了新的见解 （关于）……的形成与演化 太阳系的。

In July 2020, the Tianwen-1 mission to Mars was another great success, aiming to study the Martian environment and search for signs of water and life.

2020 年 7 月， 飞往火星的天问一号任务 是又一次巨大的成功， 旨在研究 火星环境 并寻找迹象 （关于）水和生命的。

In addition to the lunar and Mars missions, China completed the Tiangong space station at the end of 2022.

除了 月球和火星任务之外， 中国建成了 天宫空间站 在 2022 年底。

The station serves as a platform for scientific research and technology development, as well as a training ground for astronauts.

该空间站作为一个平台 （用于）科学研究 和技术开发， 同时也 （作为）训练场地 （供）宇航员（使用）。

If you're interested in learning more about China's explorations to infinity and beyond, you can visit the China Aerospace Science and Technology Corporation headquarters in Beijing or the China Space Museum,

如果你有兴趣了解更多 关于中国的探索 （前往）无穷乃至更远（的太空）， 你可以参观 中国航天科技集团总部 在北京 或者中国航天博物馆，

which features exhibits on China's space history and future plans.

那里展出了 关于中国航天历史 和未来规划的（展品）。

The Silk Road is back in action.

丝绸之路重新焕发生机。

This billion-upon-billion-dollar investment will create modern infrastructures in areas less trodden and open up vast opportunities to walk in the footsteps of those who risked their lives and adventured the trails

这项数以十亿计美元的投资 将建设现代化的基础设施 在（人们）较少踏足的地区
并开辟广阔的机会 （去）追随足迹 （那是）那些冒着生命危险的人
并沿着小径冒险（探索）的人

to find new and exciting places and riches along the way.

去寻找新奇而激动人心的地方 以及沿途的财富。

With the Belt and Road Initiative well underway, China is linking up the Silk Road and the Maritime Silk Road to create connections with more than 100 countries along its path.

随着“一带一路”倡议的稳步推进， 中国正在连接 丝绸之路和海上丝绸之路 以建立联系 与 100 多个国家 沿着这条路线。

So, strap on your boots and get yourself out to the Belt and Road and experience ancient wonders in a modern way.

所以， 系好你的靴子 并让自己走出去 前往“一带一路” 去体验古老的奇迹
以一种现代的方式。

China's gone bot-y.

中国已经变得（充满）机器人化。

While Skynet's takeover is probably a few millennia away, today many of China's industries are going bot-y!

尽管“天网”的接管（统治） 大概还要几千年之后（才会发生）， 如今中国的许多行业
正变得越来越机器人化！

Robots are doing taxes, conducting surgical operations, taking over dangerous jobs at ammunition plants, and are even made into cute little helpers rolling around banks' waiting areas

机器人正在办理税务， 进行外科手术， 接管危险的工作 在军火工厂， 甚至被做成
可爱的小助手 在银行等候区里转来转去

servicing and joking with customers. I mean, who wouldn't want an authentic Chinese dumpling made only by robots?

（它们）为顾客服务并与顾客开玩笑。 我的意思是， 谁不想（要） 一个正宗的中国饺子 完全由机器人制作的（饺子）呢?

Poverty-free is not a dream any more.

摆脱贫困不再是梦想。

By the end of 2020, China had completed the goal of poverty alleviation in the new era as scheduled.

到 2020 年底， 中国已经完成了目标 （即）脱贫攻坚 在新时代 如期（完成）。

Under the current standard, 98.99 million rural poor people have all been lifted out of poverty; 832 impoverished counties and all 128,000 impoverished villages have started their new lives.

按照现行标准， 9899 万农村贫困人口 已全部脱贫； 832 个贫困县 以及全部 12.8 万个贫困村 都开启了新生活。

One major bonus for people living in small, less developed regions of China is that there is now a tourism infrastructure being built around and invested in ancient towns,

一个重要的好处 对于生活在……的人们 中国偏远欠发达地区 是 现在有了旅游基础设施 （正在）围绕……建设 并投资于古镇，

allowing people to earn money as well as preserve their historical cultures.

使人们能够赚钱 同时也能保护 他们的历史文化。

Visiting one of these ancient towns or villages should be at the top of the list for any trip to China.

参观这些古镇或古村落之一 应该排在（清单）首位 （对于）任何一次中国之行。

New application of social media apps.

社交媒体应用的新用途。

In China there are about 900 million users who have their bank cards linked to their social media accounts, which allows users to have food, groceries, and goods delivered to their house,

在中国，大约有 9 亿用户 将他们的银行卡绑定 到他们的社交媒体账户上， 这使得用户能够 让食物、杂货和商品被送到 他们的家里，

to pay cellphone, utility or other bills through third-party plug-ins, and even hail a cab.

（能够）支付话费、水电费或其他账单 通过第三方插件， 甚至叫出租车。

The social media apps' built-in QR scanner makes all your QR purchases a breeze.

这些社交媒体应用内置的二维码扫描器 让你所有扫码购买 变得轻松（像一阵风）。

A cashless society is taking shape.

一个无现金社会正在形成。

QR codes, QR codes everywhere!

二维码，到处都是二维码！

Payment and information come in a nice, neat little package in China — QR codes.

支付和信息 以精致、整洁的小（方）包形式出现 在中国——（那就是）二维码。

While in the West, these never quite caught on, QR codes are a way of life here, from getting another person's contact information and following a publication you like,

而在西方， 这些（二维码）从未真正流行起来， 二维码在这里是一种生活方式，
从获取他人的联系方式 到关注你喜欢的公众号，

to ordering food or paying bills. If you are walking down the street and see a wrinkled old man serving some local Chinese snacks, you can be sure that you will also see a QR code somewhere

再到点餐或付账单。 如果你走在街上 看到一个满脸皱纹的老人 正在售卖一些中国地方小吃，
你可以确定 你也会在某个地方看到二维码

to scan and pay for his wares over the phone!

（用于）扫码并为他的商品付款 通过手机！

A booming sharing economy.

蓬勃发展的共享经济。

Remember those QR codes we just talked about? Well, they go even further.

还记得那些二维码 我们刚刚谈到的吗？ 嗯， 它们（的应用）甚至更广泛。

In China, the sharing economy is so vast that you can share just about anything.

在中国， 共享经济如此庞大 以至于你几乎可以共享任何东西。

But the biggest boom in today's market is shared transportation.

但最大的繁荣（领域） 在当今市场上 是共享出行。

With one little scan, you are off on your shared bike to your destination.

只需轻轻一扫， 你就出发了 骑上共享单车 前往你的目的地。

Pesky 15-minute walks from the subway have turned into 5-minute jaunts, and weekends are now spent 'share-biking' throughout the city with friends.

令人厌烦的 15 分钟步行 从地铁（到目的地） 已经变成了 5 分钟的短途骑行，
而周末现在被用来 骑共享单车逛遍全城 和朋友们（一起）。

With over 800 million people participating in China's $580 billion sharing economy, there is nowhere to go but up.

有超过 8 亿人参与 中国 5800 亿美元的共享经济， （这个市场）只会一路向上（越做越大）。

China has a first-rate car-hailing service.

中国拥有一流的网约车服务。

Can you believe that a car-hailing app has attracted investment from the top-three Internet giants of China?

你能相信吗 一个网约车应用 竟然吸引了投资 来自中国排名前三的互联网巨头?

Can you believe that a car-hailing company could be among the most valuable start-up companies in the world?

你能相信吗 一家网约车公司 竟然能跻身 最有价值的初创公司 在世界（范围内）？

The huge amount of investment makes China's car-hailing service more convenient and cost-effective.

巨额的投资 使中国的网约车服务 更便捷、更具性价比。

With a user-friendly interface, customers can simply plug in their location and destination and be on their way in a few minutes.

凭借友好的用户界面， 顾客只需输入 他们的位置和目的地 然后就能出发 在几分钟内。

In addition to regular car-hailing services, one can also request luxury cars, airport pickups and full-day car and driver rentals.

除了常规的网约车服务之外， 你还可以叫 豪华车， 机场接机
以及全天（包）车和司机租赁服务。

An English interface is available now, making the services accessible to more and more foreign people living in and visiting China.

现在（已经）提供英文界面， 使这些服务（变得）可用 （面向）越来越多的外国人
在中国生活和到访（中国）的。

Life in China is a mixed bag.

在中国的生活（像）一个五味杂陈的混合包。

While you can dine in lavish modern restaurants in China's large cities such as Beijing and Shanghai, there is still deep-rooted culture at every turn.

虽然你可以在 奢华现代的餐厅 在中国的大城市 如北京和上海（用餐）， 仍然有根深蒂固的文化
随处可见。

In a little more than an hour from Beijing's city center, you can step into rural China and tour ancient villages and even participate in homestays to learn more about traditional culture.

只需一个多小时 从北京市中心（出发）， 你就可以踏入中国乡村 游览古村落
甚至可以参加民宿（体验） 去了解更多传统文化。

China is one of those places where you can see an advanced electric car zoom by and also have handmade dumplings from a vendor for less than one US dollar.

中国是这样一些地方之一 在那里你可以看到 一辆先进的电动汽车飞驰而过
同时也能买到手工饺子 从一个小贩那里 （价格）不到一美元。

Unit 1 • Text B

The History of China（中国历史）

Ancient China produced what has become the oldest extant culture in the world.

古代中国孕育了 （而它）已成为 现存最古老的文化 在世界上。

The name 'China' comes from the Sanskrit Cina (derived from the name of the Chinese Qin dynasty, pronounced 'Chin')

“China”这个名字来自 梵语的 Cina （源自……的名字 中国秦朝， 读作 “Chin”）

which was translated as 'Cin' by the Persians and seems to have become popularized through trade along the Silk Road from China to the rest of the world.

它被波斯人音译为 “Cin” （被）波斯人 并似乎（由此）变得流行起来 通过沿丝绸之路的贸易
从中国（传）向世界其他地方。

The Romans and the Greeks knew the country as 'Seres', 'the land where silk comes from'.

罗马人和希腊人 把这个国家称为 “Seres”， 即“丝绸的产地”。

The name 'China' does not appear in print in the West until 1516 CE in Barbosa's journals narrating his travels in the East

“China”这个名字 并未以印刷形式出现 在西方，直到公元 1516 年
（才出现）在巴博萨的游记中 （那是）记述他在东方旅行的（文字）

(though the Europeans had long known of China through trade via the Silk Road).

（尽管欧洲人 早就知道中国 通过丝绸之路的贸易。）

Marco Polo, the famous explorer who familiarized Europe with China in the 13th century CE, referred to the land as 'Cathay'.

马可·波罗， 这位著名的探险家 他让欧洲熟悉了中国 在公元 13 世纪， 把这片土地称为
“Cathay” （契丹）。

In Mandarin Chinese, the country is known as 'Zhongguo' meaning 'central state' or 'middle empire'.

在普通话（汉语）中， 这个国家被称为 “Zhongguo” （中国）
意思是“中央之国”或“中间的帝国”。

Well before the advent of recognizable civilization in the region, the land was occupied by hominids.

早在……出现之前 （在）可辨认的文明 在该地区（出现）之前，
这片土地就被原始人类占据了。

Peking Man, a skull fossil discovered in 1927 CE near Beijing, lived in the area between 700,000 to 200,000 years ago,

北京猿人， （是一个）头骨化石 于公元 1927 年在北京附近发现， 生活在（这一）地区 距今 70 万至 20 万年前，

and Yuanmou Man, whose remains were found in Yuanmou in 1965 CE, inhabited the land 1.7 million years ago.

而元谋人， 其遗骸在元谋被发现 于公元 1965 年， 在 170 万年前就居住在这片土地上。

Evidence uncovered with these finds shows that these early inhabitants knew how to fashion stone tools and use fire.

与这些发现一同出土的证据 表明 这些早期居民知道如何 制作石器并使用火。

While it is commonly accepted that human beings originated in Africa and then migrated to other points around the globe, China's paleoanthropologists 'support the theory of 'regional evolution' of the origin of man'

虽然人们普遍认为 人类起源于非洲 然后迁徙到其他地方 遍布全球， 中国的古人类学家 “支持‘区域进化’的理论 关于人类起源的”

which claims an independent basis for the birth of human beings.

该理论声称 （人类起源有）独立的基础 （即）人类的诞生。

'The Shu Ape, a primate weighing only 100 to 150 grams and being similar to a mouse in size, lived in China in the Middle Eocene Epoch 4.5 to 4 million years ago.

“中华曙猿， 一种灵长类动物 体重仅 100 至 150 克 大小与老鼠相似， 生活在中国 在中始新世 距今 450 万至 400 万年前。

Its discovery posed a great challenge to the theory of the African origin of the human race'.

它的发现构成了巨大的挑战 对（这一）理论 （即）人类非洲起源说。”

This challenge is considered plausible due to genetic links between the Shu Ape fossil and both advanced and lower primates, standing, then, as a 'missing link' in the evolutionary process.

这一挑战被认为是合理的 因为（存在）遗传上的联系 在中华曙猿化石 与高级灵长类和低等灵长类之间， 因此它被视作 （进化过程中的） “缺失的一环” 在进化过程中。

However one interprets this data (the Chinese conclusions have been disputed by the international community), the solid evidence provided by other finds

无论人们如何解读这些数据 （中国的这些结论 一直受到质疑 （被）国际学术界（质疑）），（但）确凿的证据 由其他发现所提供（的证据）

substantiates a very ancient lineage of hominids and Homo sapiens in China and a high level of sophistication in early culture.

证实了 （存在）非常古老的谱系 （即）中国的原始人类和智人谱系 以及高度的（发达）程度 （在）早期文化（方面）。

One example of this is Banpo Village, near Xi'an, discovered in 1953 CE.

其中一个例子是半坡村， 位于西安附近， 于公元 1953 年被发现。

Banpo is a Neolithic village that was inhabited between 4500 and 3750 BCE and comprises 45 houses with floors sunk into the ground for greater stability.

半坡是一个新石器时代村落 它（有人）居住 在公元前 4500 年至 3750 年之间 包含 45 座房屋 （这些房屋的）地面（向下）挖入地下 以（获得）更大的稳固性。

A trench encircling the village provided both protection from attack and drainage (while also helping to fence in domestic animals) while man-made caves dug underground were used to store food.

一条环绕村落的壕沟 既提供了防护 （抵御）攻击 又（提供）排水 （同时也帮助圈养家畜） 而人工挖掘的地下洞穴 被用来储存食物。

The design of the village, and the artifacts discovered there (such as pottery and tools), argue for a very advanced culture at the time it was constructed.

村落的设计， 以及在那里发现的器物 （如陶器和工具）， 都表明 （存在）一种非常先进的文化 在它建成之时。

It has generally been accepted that the Chinese 'Cradle of Civilization' is the Yellow River Valley, which gave rise to villages sometime around 5000 BCE.

人们普遍认为 中华“文明的摇篮” 是黄河流域， 它催生了村落 大约在公元前 5000 年。

While this has been disputed, and arguments have been made for the more widespread development of communities, there is no doubt that Henan Province, in the Yellow River Valley, was the site of many early villages and farming communities.

尽管这一点一直有争议， 而且（人们）提出了论点支持 （存在）更广泛的聚落发展， 毫无疑问的是 河南省， 位于黄河流域， 是……的所在地 许多早期村落和农耕聚落。

In 2001 CE, archaeologists uncovered two skeletons 'buried in a collapsed house, which was covered with a thick layer of silt deposits from the Yellow River.

公元 2001 年， 考古学家发掘出两具骨架 “埋在一座坍塌的房屋中， （该房屋）被覆盖着 一层厚厚的淤泥沉积物 来自黄河的。

In the layer of deposits, archaeologists found more than 20 skeletons, an altar, a square, pottery, and stone and jade utensils'.

在这层沉积物中， 考古学家发现了 20 多具骨架， 一个祭坛， 一个广场， 陶器，
以及石器和玉器。”

This site was only one of many prehistoric villages in the area.

这个遗址只是……之一 许多史前村落 在该地区的。

From these small villages and farming communities grew centralized government; the first of which was the prehistoric Xia dynasty (c. 2070–1600 BCE).

从这些小村落和农耕聚落 发展出了集权的政府（国家政权）； 其中第一个就是
史前时期的夏朝（约公元前 2070–1600 年）。

The Xia dynasty was considered, for many years, more myth than fact until excavations in the 1960s and 1970s CE uncovered sites that argued strongly for its existence.

夏朝曾被认为是， 多年来， （更）像是神话而非事实 直到公元 20 世纪 60、70 年代的发掘
发现了遗址 （这些遗址）有力地证明了它的存在。

Bronze works and tombs clearly point to an evolutionary period of development between disparate Stone Age villages and a recognizable cohesive civilization.

青铜器和墓葬 清楚地指向 一个演变发展时期 （即）在分散的石器时代村落
与一个可辨认的、凝聚（统一）的文明之间。

Unit 6 • Text A

Lunar New Year Traditions（农历新年的传统）

When people talk about the 'holiday season' in the U.S., they typically refer to that period between Thanksgiving dinner and New Year's Day.

当人们谈论 美国的“节日季”时， 他们通常指的是 从感恩节晚餐 到元旦（之间的）那段时间。

But shortly after that, another massive holiday brings friends and family together in several Asian countries.

但在那之后不久， 另一个盛大的节日 把朋友和家人聚在一起 在一些亚洲国家。

The Lunar New Year, most commonly associated with the Chinese New Year or Spring Festival, typically falls sometime between January 21 and February 20 annually.

农历新年， 最常与……联系在一起 中国新年（春节）， 通常落在某个时间 在 1 月 21 日至 2 月 20 日之间 每年。

It's called the Lunar New Year because it marks the first new moon of the lunisolar calendars traditional to many East Asian countries including China, South Korea, and Vietnam,

它被称为农历新年 因为它标志着第一个新月 （属于）阴阳历的
（那是）许多东亚国家传统的（历法） 包括中国、韩国和越南，

which are regulated by the cycles of the moon and sun.

（这些历法）由……来调节 月亮和太阳的运行周期。

As the New York Times explains, 'A solar year — the time it takes Earth to orbit the sun — lasts around 365 days, while a lunar year, or 12 full cycles of the Moon, is roughly 354 days.'

正如《纽约时报》所解释的那样， “一个太阳年—— （即）地球绕太阳公转所需的时间——
大约持续 365 天， 而一个太阴年（阴历年）， 即月球完整的 12 个周期， 大约为 354 天。”

As with the Jewish lunisolar calendar, 'a month is still defined by the moon, but an extra month is added periodically to stay close to the solar year.'

与犹太阴阳历一样， “一个月仍然由月亮来界定， 但会周期性地增加一个额外的月份
以（使历法）接近太阳年。”

This is why the new year falls on a different day within that month-long window each year.

这就是为什么 新年落在不同的日期 （每年都）在那个长达一个月的窗口期内。

In China, the 15-day celebration kicks off on New Year's Eve with a family feast called a reunion dinner full of traditional Lunar New Year foods,

在中国， 为期 15 天的庆祝活动 在除夕夜拉开帷幕 以一顿家庭盛宴（开始）
（这场盛宴）被称为团圆饭 （桌上）摆满了传统的农历新年美食，

and typically ends with the Lantern Festival.

并且通常以……结束 （那就是）元宵节。

'It's really a time for new beginnings, and family gathering,' says Nancy Yao Maasbach, president of New York City's Museum of Chinese in America.

“这真的是一个（属于）……的时刻 （即）新的开始， 以及家庭团聚的时刻，”
南希·姚·马斯巴赫说， （她是）……的主席 纽约市美国华人博物馆的。

Three overarching themes, she says, are 'fortune, happiness, and health'.

三大核心主题， 她说， 就是“福气、幸福和健康”。

There is a weeklong holiday in the People's Republic of China during the Spring Festival.

有一个为期一周的假期 在中华人民共和国 在春节期间。

Ahead of that holiday comes a bustling travel period known as Chunyun, in which millions of people trek home by plane, train, and automobile to celebrate the new year with their extended families.

在那个假期之前 （会）迎来一段繁忙的出行期 被称为“春运”，
（在这段时期）数百万人长途跋涉回家 乘飞机、火车和汽车 去庆祝新年
和他们的大家庭（一起）。

Chunyun is deemed to be 'the largest human migration on the planet'.

春运被认为是 “地球上最大规模的人类迁徙”。

'When you walk around Chinatown, if you're not familiar with the layers of meaning in these festivals, you may miss them,' Maasbach says.

“当你在唐人街逛时， 如果你不熟悉 这些节日中层层叠叠的含义， 你可能会错过它们，”
马斯巴赫说。

Upside-down fu characters

倒贴的“福”字

On Chinese New Year, you'll commonly see a calligraphy character on a square of red paper, hung in a diamond shape.

在中国新年（期间）， 你通常（会）看到 一个书法汉字 （写）在一张方形的红纸上，
（它被）挂成菱形（摆放）。

The character, □ [fú], which means good luck, is hung upside down for Lunar New Year.

这个字，福 [fú]， 意思是好运， 被倒着挂起来 （以）庆祝农历新年。

'The word 'to arrive', or to begin, is a homophone for the word for upside down,' Maasbach explains.

“‘到来’，即‘开始’这个词，是.....的同音词（即）‘倒着’这个词，”
马斯巴赫解释道。

Through this bit of pictorial wordplay, the symbol effectively means that good luck is arriving, or pouring down on you.

通过这种小小的图画式文字游戏，这个符号实际上意味着 好运正在到来，
或者说正倾泻（降临）到你身上。

Red packets full of money

装满了钱的红包

Known as hóngbāo in Mandarin, in China they're traditionally gifted from an elder or parent to children, or really anyone who's unmarried.

在普通话中被称为“红包”，在中国，它们传统上是由.....赠送（即）由长辈或父母送给孩子，
或者（送给）任何未婚的人。

'It's really fun, because even if your brother is 40 and he's unmarried he still gets red envelopes,' Maasbach says.

“这真的很有趣，因为即使你哥哥已经 40 岁 而且他还没结婚 他仍然能收到红包，”
马斯巴赫说。

The custom arose out of a tradition of using coins as a gift to ward off evil spirits.

这一习俗起源于（一种）用硬币作礼物的传统 以（用来）驱邪避恶。

It's an occasion for kids to have a little fun when asking for an envelope, too.

这也是孩子们的一个机会（可以）找点乐子 在讨要红包的时候。

When asking, 'you have to say things like 'xīn nián kuài lè', or 'Happy New Year,' or 'gōng xǐ fā cái', which means 'make money in the new year'.

（他们）讨要时说，“你得说些像这样的（吉祥话）‘新年快乐’，或者‘新年快乐’，
或者‘恭喜发财’，意思是‘在新的一年里发财’。

But it kind of has a rhyme,' Maasbach says.

但它有点像押韵（的顺口溜），” 马斯巴赫说。

'You'll say, 'gōng xǐ fā cái, hóng bāo ná lái!"

“你会说，‘恭喜发财，红包拿来！’ ”

This translates to, 'Make a lot of money in the new year — now give me my red envelope!'

这句话翻译过来就是，“新的一年发大财 ——现在把红包给我！”

Firecrackers

鞭炮

Firecrackers and fireworks are often set off throughout Lunar New Year, both to ward off an ancient monster called Nian, and because it's become a raucous way to celebrate.

鞭炮和烟花 经常被燃放 在农历新年期间， 既是为了驱赶 一个叫做“年”的古老怪兽，
也是因为它已成为 一种喧闹的庆祝方式。

It's common to see families shooting off the equally festive, and non-fiery, confetti cannons on the streets of U.S. Chinatowns on New Year's Day.

常见的是（可以看到）一些家庭 燃放 同样喜庆且不冒火的 彩带礼炮 在美国唐人街的街道上
在新年（当天）。

The Lion Dance and Dragon Dance

舞狮与舞龙

Traditional dances and gymnastic performances are an exciting part of a Lunar New Year parade.

传统舞蹈和体操表演 是激动人心的一部分 （属于）农历新年游行的。

A Lion Dance typically features two performers inside the costume, operating as the creature's front and back legs.

舞狮通常由 服装内的两名表演者（构成）， （他们）扮演成 这头动物的前腿和后腿。

'It's supposed to send away any evil spirits,' Maasbach says. 'It's an opportunity to feed the lion with red envelopes.'

“它（舞狮）被认为能赶走 一切邪灵，” 马斯巴赫说。 “这是一个机会
（可以）用红包喂狮子。”

The Dragon Dance features visible puppeteers holding poles as they make the dragon move in a flowing motion.

舞龙（则）由 （可见的）举着木杆的操纵者（构成） 他们让龙移动 以一种流畅的动作。

While these two dances are among the best known, Maasbach says they're just a few examples native to specific regions.

虽然这两种舞蹈 是最著名的（舞蹈）之一， 马斯巴赫说 它们只是几个例子
（而且）源自特定地区。

'China is a very diverse country, with many different practices,' she continues.

“中国是一个非常多元的国家， （拥有）许多不同的习俗，” 她继续说道。

'The Fan Dance, the Phoenix Dance, the Lion Dance — those are all provincial expert pieces.'

“扇舞、凤舞、狮舞—— 这些都是各地方（富有）特色的节目。”

Foods

食物

Several traditional Lunar New Year foods also carry extra meaning in China, because the way they're pronounced is a homophone for another luck-related word.

一些传统的农历新年食物 也承载着额外的含义 在中国， 因为它们（名称）的发音是.....的同音词 （即）另一个与运气相关的词。

For example, the pronunciation for 'fish' in Mandarin and many other dialects is 'yú', which is the same pronunciation as 'surplus', meaning an abundance of food or wealth for the next year.

例如， “鱼”的发音 在普通话和许多其他方言中 是 “yú”， 它与“余（盈余）”发音相同，意思是食物或财富的丰裕 （那是）为来年（讨个）好彩头。

Unit 6 • Text B

Duanwu Jie（端午节）

There are many competing explanations for Duanwu Jie, the Dragon Boat Festival, which falls on the fifth day of the fifth month of the Chinese lunar calendar.

存在许多相互竞争（不同）的解释 关于端午节， （也就是）龙舟节， 它落在 五月初五
（属于）中国农历的。

All involve some combination of dragons, spirits, loyalty, honor and food — some of the most important traditions in Chinese culture.

所有这些（解释）都涉及……的某种组合 龙、神灵、忠诚、荣誉和食物
——（这些是）一些最重要的传统 （属于）中国文化。

The festival's main elements — now popular the world over — are racing long, narrow wooden boats decorated with dragons and eating sticky-rice balls wrapped in bamboo leaves,

这个节日的主要元素 ——如今在全世界都很流行—— （它们）是：划长而窄的木船（比赛）
（这些船）装饰着龙 以及吃糯米团 用竹叶包裹的，

called zongzi in Mandarin, and jung in Cantonese.

（它）在普通话中被称为粽子， 而在粤语中被称为 “jung” （粽）。

'Usually Chinese festivals are explained by the traumatic death of some great paragon of virtue,' says Andrew Chittick, a professor of East Asian Humanities at Eckerd College in Florida.

“通常，中国节日被解释为源于 （某位）惨烈的死亡 （那是）某位伟大道德典范（的死），”
安德鲁·奇蒂克说， （他是）东亚人文学教授 （供职于）佛罗里达州的埃克德学院。

And so the story goes with Qu Yuan, an advisor in the court of Chu during the Warring States period of ancient China who was exiled by the emperor for perceived disloyalty.

屈原的故事也正是如此， （他是）楚国朝廷的一位谋士 （那是）中国古代战国时期
他被君主放逐 因为（被认定）不忠。

Qu Yuan had proposed a strategic alliance with the state of Qi in order to fend off the threatening state of Qin, but the emperor didn't buy it and sent Qu Yuan off to the wilderness.

屈原曾提议 与齐国结成战略联盟 以（此来）抵御 （当时）威胁（各国）的秦国，
但君主并不买账（不接受） 并把屈原流放到了荒远之地。

Unfortunately, Qu Yuan was right about the threat presented by the Qin, who soon captured and imprisoned the Chu emperor.

不幸的是， 屈原是对的 （在）关于秦国构成的威胁（这一点上），
（因为）秦国很快俘虏并囚禁了 楚国君主。

The next Chu king surrendered the state to their rivals.

下一任楚王 把国家拱手让出（投降） （给）他们的敌人。

Upon hearing the tragic news, Qu Yuan drowned himself in the Miluo River in Hunan Province in 278 B.C.

听到这一悲惨的消息后， 屈原投江自尽 在汨罗江 在湖南省 在公元前 278 年。

In the first origin story of zongzi, told during the early Han dynasty, Qu Yuan became a water spirit after his death.

在关于粽子的第一个起源故事中， （它）流传于汉朝早期， 屈原死后变成了一位水神（水鬼）
在他死后。

'You can think of it as a ghost, a spirit energy that has to be appeased. There are a variety of ways one might appease a ghost but the best and most enduring is to give it food,' explains Chittick.

“你可以把它想象成一个鬼魂， 一种灵体能量 （它）必须被安抚。 有各种各样的方法
（人们）可以用来安抚一个鬼魂 但最好且最持久的（方法） 就是给它食物，” 奇蒂克解释道。

For years after Qu Yuan's death, his supporters threw rice in the water to feed his spirit, but the food, it was said, was always intercepted by a water dragon.

在屈原死后的许多年里， 他的追随者把米投入水中 来喂养他的亡灵， 但是这些食物，据说，
总是被一条水龙截走。

(Master Chef Martin Yan, author and host of the pioneering Yan Can Cook TV show, suggests there may have been truth to this: 'Some freshwater fish — like catfish — grow so huge that the Chinese considered them dragons.')

（名厨马丁·严， （他既是）作者又是主持人 （那是）开先河的电视节目《严氏烹饪》的，
认为这（种说法）可能确有根据： “一些淡水鱼——比如鲶鱼—— 能长到如此巨大
以至于中国人把它们当作龙。”）

After a couple of centuries of this frustration, Qu Yuan came back to tell the people to wrap the rice in leaves, or stuff it into a bamboo stalk, so the dragon couldn't eat it.

在这种（徒劳的）挫败持续了几个世纪之后， 屈原回来告诉人们 要把米包进叶子里，
或者塞进竹筒里， 这样龙就吃不到了。

It was only generations later that people began to retroactively credit Qu Yuan's erstwhile lifesavers with starting the rice-ball-tossing tradition.

直到几代人之后 人们才开始追溯性地把……归功于 屈原往日的“救命恩人”
（认为）是（他们）开创了投米团（粽子）的传统。

To make sense of how the water dragon gets into the story, or indeed of the boats carved with dragons on them, we need to go back further in time — more than 6,000 years ago, the earliest dated figure of a dragon found within the boundaries of modern China.

要弄明白水龙是如何进入这个故事的， 或者（要弄明白）那些刻有龙的船（的由来），
我们需要在时间上回溯得更远 ——（回到）6000 多年前， （那是）迄今年代最早的龙的图像
（它）发现于现代中国的疆域内。

'One of the most important mythical creatures in Chinese mythology, the dragon is the controller of the rain, the river, the sea, and all other kinds of water; symbol of divine power and energy .... In the imperial era it was identified as the symbol of imperial power,' writes Deming An, Ph.D., a professor of folklore at the Institute of Literature, Chinese Academy of Social Sciences, in Beijing, and co-author of Handbook of Chinese Mythology.

“作为中国神话中最重要的神话生物之一 （即）在中国神话里， 龙是雨、 河、海
以及所有其他各种水的掌控者； （它是）神圣力量与能量的象征..... 在帝制时代
它被认定为皇权的象征，” 安得明博士写道， （他是）民俗学教授 （供职于）文学研究所，
（那是）中国社会科学院（的研究所）， 在北京， 也是《中国神话手册》的合著者。

'In people's imaginations, dragons usually live in water and are the controllers of rain.'

“在人们的想象中， 龙通常生活在水里 并且是雨的掌控者。”

Dragon boat racing is ascribed to organized celebrations of Qu Yuan beginning in the 5th or 6th century A.D. But scholars say the boats were first used hundreds of years earlier, perhaps for varied reasons.

赛龙舟被归因于 （人们）有组织地纪念屈原的活动 （这些活动）始于公元 5 或 6 世纪。
但学者们表示 这些船首次被使用（的时间）要早数百年， 也许是出于各种（不同的）原因。

On the lunar calendar, May is the summer solstice period, the crucial time when rice seedlings were transplanted.

在农历上， 五月是夏至时节， （这是）关键时期 （那是）移栽稻秧的时候。

At the same time, says An, 'According to Chinese traditional belief, the date figured with double '5' is extremely unlucky.'

与此同时， 安（博士）说， “根据中国的传统观念，
（带有）双‘五’的这一天（五月初五）极其不吉利。”

To ensure a good harvest, southern Chinese people would have asked the dragons to watch over their crops, says Jessica Anderson Turner, a Handbook of Chinese Mythology contributor who holds a Ph.D. in folklore from Indiana University.

为了确保丰收， 中国南方人 会（曾）请求龙 来守护他们的庄稼， 杰西卡·安德森·特纳说，
（她是）《中国神话手册》的撰稿人 （她）拥有民俗学博士学位 （毕业于）印第安纳大学。

They would have decorated their boats with ornate dragon carvings, 'and the rowing was symbolic of the planting of the rice back in the water,' Anderson Turner explains.

他们（会曾）用精美的龙雕装饰他们的船 （即）用华丽的龙形雕刻（装饰），
“而划桨（的动作）象征着 把稻谷重新种回水里，” 安德森·特纳解释道。

This jibes with Yan's explanation of the symbolism behind the shape of zongzi: tetrahedral.

这与……相吻合 严（大厨）对……象征意义的解释 （即）关于粽子形状（背后）的：
（它是）四面体（形）的。

'The points are intended to resemble the horn of a cow,' Yan says, 'which was a sacred symbol in the ancient agrarian culture for blessings and abundant crops.'

“这些尖角旨在模仿 牛角，” 严（大厨）说， “（牛角）曾是一种神圣的象征
在古代农耕文化中 （它象征）祈福和五谷丰登。”

In another interpretation, Chittick argues that the dragon boat races were 'initially a military exercise' in the Hubei area, home of the state of Chu, which took place during the solstice because that's when the river was highest.

在另一种解读中， 奇蒂克认为 龙舟竞赛（最初）是 “一种军事演练” 在湖北地区，
（那是）楚国的故土， （它）发生在夏至期间 因为那是河水水位最高的时候。

'Small boats were an important part of warfare. Then they turned it into a spectator sport.'

“小船是战争的重要组成部分。 后来他们把它变成了一项观赏性运动。”

These disparate histories and stories blended over time into the encompassing myth of Qu Yuan, seemingly without issue to the celebrators.

这些各不相同的史实和故事 随着时间的推移融合成了 （一个）包罗万象的屈原传说，
对庆祝者而言似乎毫无违和（矛盾）。

'The combining of stories is how people make sense of things,' says Anderson Turner.

“（各种）故事的融合 就是人们理解事物的方式，” 安德森·特纳说。

'Myths are always changing to fit the needs of the community. For a lot of people, you can have both history and culture; both can be authentic and true.'

“神话总是在变化 以适应（社会）群体的需要。 对于很多人来说，
你可以同时拥有历史和文化； 两者都可以是真实且可信的。”

Even the Qu Yuan story isn't the only legend behind the celebration of Duanwu Jie.

即便是屈原的故事，也不是唯一的传说 （那是）关于端午节庆祝（起源）的。

Some northern Chinese people, Chittick explains, told the tale of a man who fled to the woods after being wronged by his lord.

一些中国北方人， 奇蒂克解释说， 讲述了一个男子的故事 他逃进了树林
在（他）被他的君主冤枉之后。

Trying to flush the man out, the lord burned down the forest and accidentally killed the loyal servant.

为了把这个人逼出来， 那位君主放火烧毁了森林 却意外地害死了这位忠心的臣子。

Another competing myth, from what is now the southern province of Fujian, is that of Wu Zixu, who was also wronged by his king.

另一个与之竞争（并列）的传说， （它）来自如今的南方省份福建，
（那就）是关于伍子胥的， 他同样被他的君王冤枉。

Wu Zixu's story involves revenge, triumphant battles, the whipping of his old foe's corpse, and suicide.

伍子胥的故事涉及复仇、 （以及）节节胜利的战斗、 鞭打旧敌尸体， 以及自尽。

As a final act, he asked that, once dead, his head be removed and placed on the city gate so he could watch the invaders take over his betrayers.

作为最后的（一个）举动， 他要求，在自己死后， 把他的头砍下来挂在城门上
这样他就能（亲眼）看着入侵者 （来）接管（征服）那些背叛他的人。

The body of Wu Zixu was tossed in the river and his fury is said to create raging tides, and so he is worshipped as a river god in parts of China — which is why some connect him with the Dragon Boat Festival.

伍子胥的尸身 被抛入江中 而他的愤怒据说（会）掀起汹涌的潮水，
因此他在中国一些地方被当作河神供奉 在中国的一些地区 ——这就是为什么有人把他
与端午节联系起来。

But Qu Yuan became the face of Duanwu Jie, because he was a prolific poet whose work was studied and loved by generations of Chinese scholars who followed him.

但屈原成了端午节的（代表）面孔， 因为他是一位多产的诗人 他的作品被（人们）研读和喜爱
（被）一代又一代的中国文人 （那些）追随他的（文人）。

'One reason Qu Yuan wins the drowning war is that his story was written in historical texts — over and over,' says Anderson Turner.

“屈原能在‘投江之争’中胜出的一个原因 在于他的故事被写进了史书
——而且一遍又一遍，” 安德森·特纳说。

Having demonstrated both a love for his country and contempt for the ungracious ruling class, he is known as the People's Poet.

（他）既展现了对祖国的热爱 又展现了对（那个）刻薄统治阶层的蔑视，
他被称为“人民的诗人”。

For the Chinese, Qu Yuan has transcended the simple story of his self-sacrifice, coming to represent the very embodiment of patriotism.

对中国人来说， 屈原已经超越了 （仅仅是）自我牺牲的简单故事， （转而）成为……的化身
（即）爱国主义的化身。